Drugs and substance abuse

Goal: Understand common drugs abused and ways of controlling drug abuse

Specific objectives:

- Discuss commonly abused drugs and its effects in our health
- Gain skills and knowledge on behavior change communication

Drug abuse – is the excessive use of a substance, especially alcohol or a drug. This is a compulsive, excessive, and self-damaging use of habit forming drugs or substances, leading to addiction or dependence, serious physiological injury (such as damage to kidneys, liver, heart) and/or psychological harm (such as dysfunctional behavior patterns, hallucinations, memory loss), or death. Also called substance abuse

Classifications of drugs

Drugs may be categorized or classified according to certain shared symptomatology or effects. Drugs from each of these categories can affect a person's central nervous system and impair a person's normal faculties, including a person's ability to safely operate a motor vehicle.

- *Central Nervous System (CNS) Depressants* - CNS Depressants slow down the operations of the brain and the body. Examples include alcohol, barbiturates, anti-anxiety tranquilizers (e.g., Valium, Librium, Xanax, Prozac, and Thorazine)

- *CNS Stimulants* - CNS Stimulants accelerate the heart rate and elevate the blood pressure and "speed-up" or over-stimulate the body. Examples include Cocaine, "Crack", Amphetamines and Methamphetamine ("Crank").

- *Hallucinogens* - Hallucinogens cause the user to perceive things differently than they actually are. Examples include LSD, Peyote, Psilocybin and MDMA (Ecstasy).

- *Dissociative Anesthetics* - It includes drugs that inhibit pain by cutting off or dissociating the brain's perception of the pain. PCP and its analogs are examples of Dissociative Anesthetics.

- *Narcotic Analgesics* - A narcotic analgesic relieves pain, induces euphoria and creates mood changes in the user. Examples of narcotic analgesics include Opium, Codeine, Heroin, Demerol, Darvon, Morphine, Methadone, Vicodin and OxyContin.

- *Inhalants* - Inhalants include a wide variety of breathable substances that produce mind-altering results and effects. Examples include Toluene, plastic cement, paint, gasoline, paint thinners, hair sprays and various anesthetic gases.

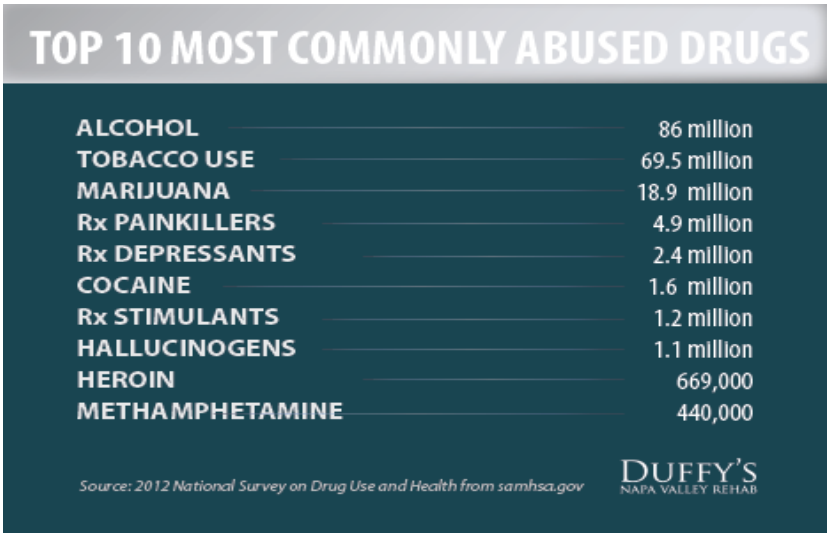
- *Cannabis* - Cannabis is the scientific name for marijuana. The active ingredient in cannabis is delta-9 tetrahydrocannabinol. This category includes cannabinoids and synthetics like Dronabinol.

Commonly abused drugs

- *Alcohol* - In chemistry, an alcohol is any organic compound in which the hydroxyl functional group is bound to a saturated carbon atom. The term alcohol originally referred to the primary alcohol ethyl alcohol, the predominant alcohol in alcoholic

beverages

- *Tobacco* - is a product prepared from the leaves of the tobacco plant by curing them. The plant is categorized within the genus *Nicotiana* of the Solanaceae (nightshade) family
- *Marijuana* - Cannabis, also known as marijuana and by numerous other names, is a preparation of the Cannabis plant intended for use as a psychoactive drug or medicine
- *Pain killers* - An analgesic or painkiller is any member of the group of drugs used to achieve analgesia, relief from pain. Analgesic drugs act in various ways on the peripheral and central nervous systems
- *RX sedatives* - Prescription medications that act as central nervous system depressants. Barbiturates are prescription sedatives or "sleeping pills" Valium and benzodiazepines are prescription "tranquilizers.



- *RX stimulants* - Prescription stimulants were used historically to treat asthma, obesity, neurological disorders, and a variety of other ailments, before their potential for abuse and addiction became apparent

- *Cocaine*- Cocaine, also known as benzoylmethylecgonine, is a strong stimulant mostly used as a recreational drug. It is commonly snorted, inhaled, or injected into the veins
- Hallucinogens - A hallucinogen is a psychoactive agent which can cause hallucinations, perception anomalies, and other substantial subjective changes in thoughts, emotion, and consciousness. The common types of hallucinogens are psychedelics, dissociative, or deliriants
- *Heroin* - also known as diamorphine and commonly known by its street names of smack, boy, horse, brown, black, tar, and others is an analgesic originally synthesized by in 1874

*******Group work and presentation ********

Identify effects of drugs and substance abuse to: Individuals; Household and Community

Illnesses associated with drug abuse

- *HIV* - The human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) causes HIV infection and the acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS).
- *Depression* - A depressive disorder is a syndrome (group of symptoms) that reflects a sad, blue mood exceeding normal sadness or grief. Depressive disorders are

characterized not only by negative thoughts, moods, and behaviors but also by specific changes in bodily functions (for example, eating, sleeping, and sexual activity).

- *Erectile dysfunction* - Erectile dysfunction (ED), also known as impotence, is the inability to achieve or sustain an erection for satisfactory sexual activity.

- *Schizophrenia* - Sometimes colloquially but inaccurately referred to as split personality disorder, schizophrenia is a chronic, severe, debilitating mental illness

- *Steroid withdrawal symptoms* - can mimic many other medical problems. Weakness, fatigue, decreased appetite, weight loss, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea(which can lead to fluid and electrolyte abnormalities), and abdominal pain are common. Blood pressure can become too low, leading to dizziness or fainting. Blood sugar levels may drop. Women also may note menstrual changes. Less often, joint pain, muscle aches, fever, mental changes, or elevations of calcium may be noted.

- *Stress* - is a fact of nature in which forces from the inside or outside world affect the individual. The individual responds to stress in ways that affect the individual, as well as their environment. Due to the overabundance of stress in our modern lives, we usually think of stress as a negative experience, but from a biological point of view, stress can be a neutral, negative, or positive experience.

- *Stroke* - also known as a cerebrovascular accident or CVA, occurs when part of the brain loses its blood supply and the part of the body that the blood-deprived brain cells control stops working. This loss of blood supply can be ischemic because of lack of blood flow, or hemorrhagic because of bleeding into brain tissue. A stroke is a medical emergency because strokes can lead to death or permanent disability, plus there are now opportunities to treat ischemic strokes but that treatment needs to be started in the first few hours after the signs of a stroke begin

- *Hepatitis C infection* - is an infection of the liver caused by the hepatitis C virus (HCV). It is difficult for the human immune system to eliminate hepatitis C from the body, and infection with help C usually becomes chronic
- *Microcephaly* - is a medical condition in which the circumference of the head is smaller than normal because the brain has not developed properly or has stopped growing.
- *Low blood pressure* - also called hypotension, is blood pressure low enough that the flow of blood to the organs of the body is inadequate and symptoms and/or signs of low blood flow develop shock.
- *An aortic aneurysm* - involves the aorta, the major artery that leaves the heart to supply blood to the body. An aortic aneurysm is dilation or bulging of the aorta.
- *Others* – child abuse, nose bleeding, brain damage, alcoholism, cancer, Hepatitis B, chronic pain, suicide, antisocial personality disorder, learning disability, sexual problems, anxiety, hypersomnia, hyper sensitivity, domestic violence,

Behavior change communication

Behavior change communication (BCC) is an interactive process of any intervention with

individuals, communities to develop communication strategies to promote positive behaviors which are appropriate to their settings.

******Group work*********

What are the importance of behavior change communication?

Process

- Situation analysis
- Audience analysis
- Content analysis
- Problem statement

Message development process

- Existing behaviors
- Desired behaviors
- Benefits of desired behavious
- Difficulties of desired behavious
- Alternative behavious

Stages of change:

- Awareness
- Accept responsibility
- Perception of options
- Evaluate options
- Making choices
- Experiment behavious
- Habitual behavior

Audience segmentation:

- People mostly affected
- People directly influencing them
- People indirectly influencing them

Chanel mix:

- Community dialogue
- There tools
- Interpersonal
- Mass media
- Outdoor advertising

Factors affecting BCC

- Intention;
- Environmental constraints;
- Skills;
- Anticipated outcomes (or attitude);
- Norms;
- Self-standards;
- Emotion;
- Self-efficacy.